ANGIE AND ARTIE

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PRODUCTION NOTE: The choice not to include dialogue and to keep written and numerical information to a minimum is intentional. Nothing essential to understanding the story requires the audience to hear speech, read text, or recognize letters or numbers.

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FIRST DRAFT

CONTACT INFO WITHHELD

EXT. PARK - DAY

ANGIE NEER, a small child in dungarees with a LITTLE PINK NOTEBOOK in the front pocket, walks along a park path with MR. NEER, her Dad.

They stop at an ice cream vendor beside a noticeboard. Soon they're both happily digging into cups of ice cream with tiny wooden spoons.

While her Dad pays, a TEENAGER cycles up, hops off, and staples a FLYER to the noticeboard. A picture of a KITE soaring against a blue sky.

Angie licks her wooden spoon. Looks at the flyer. Tilts her head.

She tugs her Dad's sleeve and points to the flyer. Dad looks. Kneels to her level.

Angie points eagerly at the kite flyer, then at Dad.

Dad grins, shakes his head, and points at her.

Angie points to herself, pleasantly surprised. Dad nods and tousles her hair.

Angie's face lights up. She bounces with joy!

Her ice cream tips-- Dad's hand shoots out and catches it.

Angie throws her arms around him. Dad returns the hug as best he can with an ice cream in each hand.

INT. NEER FAMILY GARAGE - DAY

Angie sits at her LITTLE WORKBENCH, right next to an adult-sized workbench with computers on it.

She draws a picture of a kite in the last square of a calendar. The first day of the week is already crossed out. She hangs it up next to the Little Workbench.

She puts her hands on her hips, determined smile.

In her Little Pink Notebook, she draws stick figure drawings of: a kite sail, two cross sticks, a ball of string. She places the pencil to her chin, thinking. Her brow furrows.

INT. ANGIE'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

Angie still has a furrowed brow. Her Mom, MRS. NEER tucks her into bed. Mom kisses Angie's forehead. Her brow finally relaxes, eyelids drooping. Mom clicks off the light, leaving only a little night light.

EXT. NEER FAMILY HOUSE - NIGHT TO DAY LAPSE

INSERT: CALENDAR -- A cross in the calendar marks another day passing.

INT. NEER KITCHEN TABLE - DAY

Breakfast. Dad, dressed for work under an apron, cooks eggs, sausage, and beans. Mom, wearing a pantsuit, reads a newspaper.

Dad slides eggs, sausage, and beans onto a plate. Mom cuts up the sausage for Angie, then hands it to her. Angie smiles at them. They smile back.

Mom goes back to reading the newspaper. Angie is about to take a bite, but then looks at the paper, tilts her head, thinking.

She tugs on Mom's sleeve. Mom turns to her. Angie points at the paper. Mom looks at the paper. Then nods to Angie. Angie smiles.

INT. NEER FAMILY GARAGE - DAY - LATER

Dad is at the big workbench with the computer. He makes notes in a Big Purple Notebook, brow furrowed (like Angie's) deep in thought.

Next to him, Angie is at her Little Workbench. She takes the newspaper, takes two rough tree branches, and sticks them to the newspaper with white glue.

She then takes a ball of string and wraps (not ties) it around the center where the branches cross, then glues the intersection.

She sits back and waits.

EXT. NEER FAMILY BACKYARD - DAY

Angie carries the newspaper kite into her backyard.

Next door, a boy Angie's age, ARTIE STICK, wearing paint-stained clothing, is looking at a frog intently, drawing it in a LITTLE GREEN SKETCHBOOK. In his backyard, laundry is hung up on a clothesline.

He looks up, sees Angie, smiles and waves. Angie smiles and waves back.

Artie goes back to drawing the frog, tongue sticking out in concentration.

Angie sticks a finger in her mouth then holds it up to the air. The breeze slightly shifts her hair. She nods to herself. She holds up the newspaper kite. Waits for a strong gust.

A gust comes. It lifts the newspaper kite in the air. It takes flight. For a second. Then the newspaper rips from the breeze, and the kite crashes into a puddle, soaking it.

Angie scrunches her face. A cringe. She studies the soggy wreckage. Her brow furrows. She tilts her head.

Artie comes over and stands next to her. She doesn't notice him at first. Then when she does, she nods, once, sadly. Artie also looks at the kite. Then looks to his family's laundry, which flaps in the breeze.

Artie gently tugs on Angie's shoulder. Angie looks at him. He motions for her to follow him.

INT. STICK FAMILY CRAFT ROOM - DAY

Bolts and scraps of fabric. A sewing machine. Patterns. Yarn. Canvas. Watercolors. Acrylics.

A LITTLE ART STATION is in the corner of the room. It's covered in drawings of animals and flowers. They're unmistakably a child's work, but careful and observant.

Nearby, the same subjects appear in accomplished paintings around the big art station.

Artie heads over to bolts of fabric, touching each. Some are stretchy. Some are stiff. Angie heads over to some posterboard, shaking it. It makes a WOBBLE-WOBBLE noise.

Both Artie and Angie look around the room. Many choices. Then they look at each other, unsure.

Suddenly, Angie's eyebrows raise. She holds up two fingers, close together. (Smaller?)

MOMENTS LATER

Angie and Artie re-enter the room, this time, with MR. STICK, his Dad.

Artie points to the fabrics and papers. His Dad looks at the papers, then back to the kids, smirking.

Mr. Stick selects a fabric. Measures a tiny square against a ruler. His tongue pokes out in concentration as he cuts.

Artie does the same thing while watching him.

INT. NEER FAMILY GARAGE - DUSK

Six material samples cover Angie's Little Workbench.

Angie starts using white glue to glue some toothpicks to the material, making little test kites.

MOMENTS LATER - NIGHT

The test kites are prepared and set out for the glue to dry. Mr. Stick knocks at the garage door. Angie pats Artie on the back.

Artie smiles. His father picks him up and carries him. Angie and Artie wave at each other as Mr. Stick takes Artie home.

INSERT: CALENDAR -- A cross in the calendar marks another day passing.

INT. NEER FAMILY KITCHEN TABLE - DAY

Breakfast. Mrs. Neer, casually dressed, makes waffles while Angie, still in pajamas, draws in her Little Pink Notebook, her breakfast getting cold.

Mr. Neer enters dressed for work, kisses Mrs. Neer, and takes the waffle she hands him. He peers over Angie's shoulder: six numbered test kites drawn in a grid.

Mrs. Neer sits with her breakfast, studies Angie's drawings, then tilts her head and furrows her brow. Angie looks up expectantly.

INT. NEER FAMILY LIVING ROOM - DAY

Mrs. Neer sits in a chair in the living room. Next to her is a rotary fan.

Angie (fully dressed) and Artie look at the fan. Artie takes a tape measure out of his pocket, and Angie brings over the test kites.

MOMENTS LATER

The kites are perched on the edge of a cardboard box in front of the fan. Mrs. Neer holds onto Angie for safety as Angie presses the fan button.

The test kites go flying, some of them further than others. When they land, Artie goes around with the tape measure, and writes in Angie's notebook.

They repeat the experiment two more times.

MOMENTS LATER

A new experiment. The six material samples are stretched across six little openings in a sheet of cardboard.

Angie turns the fan to low. Kite #2 doesn't flutter. Kite #5 flutters violently. The rest flutter a little.

Angie hits the button for medium. Kite #2 starts to flutter a little, and Kite #5 starts to deform.

Finally, Angie turns it to high, and Kite #5 RIPS, audibly. Angie and Artie freeze. Mrs. Neer winces.

Angie turns off the fan.

MOMENTS LATER

The two of them are huddled close over the notebook. Tally marks next to the kite drawings. Kite #5 has the most tally marks, but Angie draws a rip through it and crosses it out.

The kite material with the most tally marks remaining is #4. Angie circles it. Artie nods and gives Angie a thumbs-up.

INT. STICK FAMILY CRAFT ROOM - DAY

Artie shows Mr. Stick the winning test kite. He then stretches his arms out with his palms up. (Bigger.)

Mr. Stick happily cuts Artie a large piece of the material.

INT. NEER FAMILY GARAGE - DAY

At the Little Workbench, Angie once again "ties" together the branches by looping string around their intersection and securing it with white glue. In the background, Artie is working with the material, sewing with a needle.

Angie inspects the work. Eyebrow raised, head tilted, worried expression.

Then Artie waves Angie over. He shows off the back -- he's made little pockets for securing the branches. And then, with a flourish, he displays the front.

A simple, but not crude, representation of both Artie and Angie.

Angie's eyes go wide, her mouth is open. She loves it! Unprompted, she gives Artie a hug.

EXT. NEER FAMILY BACKYARD - DAY

They take the kite, secured with string, to the backyard. Artie holds the string.

Mr. & Mrs. Neer come out onto the back patio with coffee, sitting on a two-person swing watching the kids play.

Mr. & Mrs. Stick knock on the Neer's back gate. Mrs. Neer welcomes them in. The four parents watch from the Neer's patio.

Angie's hair blows a little, she sticks a finger in her mouth, then holds it up to the wind. Satisfied, she holds the kite with both hands over her head.

A strong gust. The wind catches it. It's aloft for a moment, then sinks back down. Not a crash, but not really flying.

Mr. Neer looks at Mrs. Neer, and they nod to each other, sadly.

MOMENTS LATER

They try again. This time, a stronger gust catches the kite. Angie's ecstatic as it wobbles, not steady, but clearly in flight. Then disaster: the string in the middle comes loose!

Angie and Artie chase after the kite, which doesn't go too far before they're able to catch it.

MOMENTS LATER

Angie and Artie are also on the patio while their parents talk. They look at the kite. Artie has his tongue out. Angie has a furrowed brow and tilted head.

Mr. and Mrs. Neer look at each other. Mrs. Neer kisses Mr. Neer on the cheek. Mr. Neer gets up and retrieves a softball and a wiffle ball from a bin.

He taps Angie on the shoulder. Angie doesn't turn around, she just concentrates intently on the kite, and holds up a finger.

Mr. Neer waits patiently. For a moment. Then he clears his throat, gently.

Angie blinks, then looks over.

MOMENTS LATER

Mr. Neer tosses Angie the softball. She catches it, reeling back, then throws it back. It bounces short of him.

He tosses the wiffle ball. Easy catch. Easy throw.

Angie's eyes light up. She takes both balls and tosses them simultaneously. The wiffle ball sails higher.

She does it again. Same result.

ANGLE ON - ARTIE AT PATIO

Back at the patio, Artie looks at the end of the string that came loose. He studies it, tongue out. He then looks to his right.

He sees Mr. Neer's tied shoelaces. Then he looks back to the string. Then to the shoelaces. Now his eyes light up.

He looks up at his Mom and Dad. They're smiling. His mother smiles and taps her temple.

Angie returns carrying both balls. Artie still holds the string. Behind her, the sun hangs low on the horizon.

Angie and Artie notice it.

They look at each other.

EXT. NEER & STICK HOMES - DUSK TO NIGHT

INSERT: CALENDAR -- A cross in the calendar marks another day passing.

EXT. LIBRARY - DAY

Angie and Artie ride bicycles, bringing the kite with them. A picture of books marks the building they enter as a library.

INT. LIBRARY - DAY

Angie and Artie go to the librarian's desk. The LIBRARIAN smiles and brings them to a shelf in the kids' section. She kneels to their level and picks out a book.

CLOSE ON: BOOK -- The cover has pictures of flying things: An airplane, a kite, a bird, a butterfly.

MOMENTS LATER

Angie and Artie look through the book, flipping through pages.

They flip through illustrations of birds, butterflies and airplanes.

They eventually find the kites section. The first pages they see show different kite shapes, including the type that they made.

They turn the page. A diagram shows a kite with and without a tail.

Another page. Close-up illustrations of knots and a bridle.

Angie takes out her Little Pink Notebook. Artie takes out his Little Green Sketchbook. Angie tilts her head, Artie sticks his tongue out. The pages in the notebooks get filled in.

INT. NEER FAMILY GARAGE - DAY

Artie constructs a balanced tail, checking his sketchbook for notes, while Angie finds two light wooden dowels to use.

MOMENTS LATER

Artie holds down the knot as Angie carefully ties the string to the kite, this time, securing it properly.

MOMENTS LATER

Angie tries to sew the tail on. She looks unsure. Artie encourages her as she does it, putting his hand on her shoulder.

She succeeds. They have a well-designed, fully featured kite. They hold it up together in triumph.

EXT. NEER & STICK HOMES - DUSK TO NIGHT

INSERT: CALENDAR -- A cross in the calendar marks another day passing.

The next day is the circled day with the kite -- Kite Festival Day.

EXT. THE PARK - DAY

The two families arrive, Artie carrying the kite and Angie the string. The two look up.

There are already kites of various shapes and sizes flying.

EXT. THE PARK (HILL) - DAY

The parents set up a little picnic, while Angie and Artie look nervous. They place hands on each other's shoulders and nod to each other.

The wind blows Angie's hair. She puts a finger in her mouth, then holds it to the wind. She nods and gives Artie a thumbs-up.

She holds the kite up to the wind.

It flutters.

Flutters more.

Angie lets it go. It takes flight. It's working.

Artie gives it a bit more string, letting it climb higher. Angie and Artie's eyes sparkle with joy.

The parents look on with pride.

And then... Angie's hair stops blowing in the wind.

The kite starts to fall. Slowly at first, then... faster.

It lands, and is caught in a tree.

The parents help retrieve the kite.

Another attempt. Angie waits for another gust. It comes. The kite flies for another moment... it's almost ready to join the others...

...then... a droplet of rain on Artie's head. Distant thunder RUMBLES.

All the kites are starting to come down.

Artie and Angie are crushed. Their parents come by, smiling, tousling their hair, proud. Artie and Angie hug them, but they're still sad.

INT. ANGIE'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

Angie's dad tucks her into bed. She's still frowning. He kisses her forehead. The frown doesn't go away, but it lessens.

Angie's father leaves, clicking the lights off with an audible click, leaving only a little night light. Angie rolls over on her side, curling up. Eventually, she drifts off to sleep.

INT. NEER KITCHEN TABLE - DAY

Angie is in her pajamas. Today, Dad is cooking breakfast, oatmeal with strawberries, while Mom is dressed in her pantsuit, reading the paper.

Angie sits down at the table. She looks over the oatmeal. She smiles when Dad brings it over, but the smile is subdued.

She looks over at Mom's newspaper. She smiles a little bit, lets out a little laugh. Then she digs into her oatmeal, taking a spoonful.

Mrs. Neer flips the paper around. On the back of the paper, a black and white picture of a sailboat.

Angie double-takes when she sees the sailboat picture. She immediately furrows her brow and tilts her head.

Her mother notices. She slyly grins. Mr. Neer looks over. Mrs. Neer tilts her head towards Angie, who is absorbed in thought. Mr. Neer also grins and tousles Angie's hair.

INT. STICK LIVING ROOM - DAY

SFX: DOORBELL

Mrs. Stick goes to answer it. It's Angie. Mrs. Stick nods to her.

Artie comes to the door. Angie smiles. Big hug. Artie is confused.

Angie takes out her Little Pink Notebook. Folded inside is a torn piece of newspaper -- the picture of the sailboat.

Artie looks at it, puzzled.

Angie then flips to a page. She's drawn a sail. Next to it, the kite material.

Next page: a mast. Next to it, one of the lightweight dowels.

Next page: the sail tied to the mast. Next to it, the knots they learned.

Artie looks at her, not getting it at first. Then... realisation. And excitement.

INT. THE LIBRARY - DAY

Angie and Artie show the librarian the picture of the sailboat. Artie takes out his Little Green Sketchbook. He's drawn a picture of a little model sailboat. The sail is their old kite, still bearing Artie's picture of the two of them.

SERIES OF STILL IMAGES:

- Artie and Angie look up sailboats in the library.

- Artie and Angie find some balsa wood they can use.

- Mr. Stick helps them form the wood into a boat shape.

- Mrs. Neer helps them seal the gaps with caulk.

- Artie secures the kite -- now the sail -- to a mast with knots.

- They take their boat to the lake in the park.

- It floats.

THE END